LEARNING
MADE SIMPLE

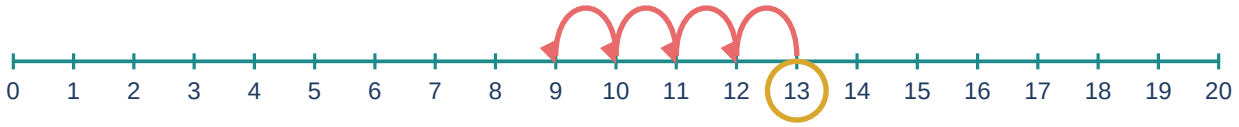
Count Back

Grade 1 Math | Subtraction Fact Strategies

Name: _____ Date: _____

Start at the big number. Hop back to subtract.

Example: 13 - 4 = 9. Start at 13.



12 - 3 = ☐ Draw the hops above the line.

15 - 2 = ☐ Draw the hops above the line.

11 - 4 = ☐ Draw the hops above the line.

© 2026 Learning Made Simple

LEARNING
MADE SIMPLE

Count Up to Find the Difference

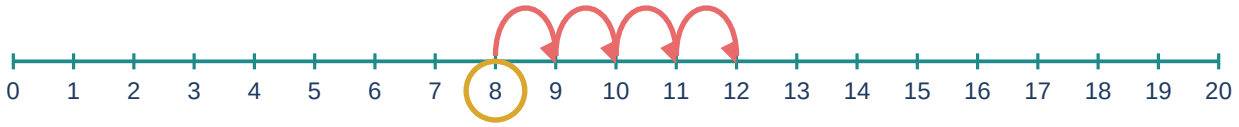
Grade 1 Math | Subtraction Fact Strategies

Name: _____ Date: _____

Start at the small number. Count up to the big number.

Counting up can help a lot when the numbers are close together.

Example: 12 - 8 = 4. Count up 4 hops: 9, 10, 11, 12.



14 - 11 = ☐ Count up from 11 to 14.

14
11

15 - 13 = ☐ Draw the hops above the line.

11 - 7 = ☐ Draw the hops above the line.

© 2026 Learning Made Simple

LEARNING
MADE SIMPLE

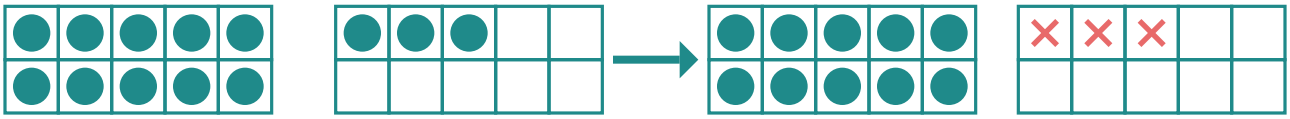
First, Get to 10

Grade 1 Math | Subtraction Fact Strategies

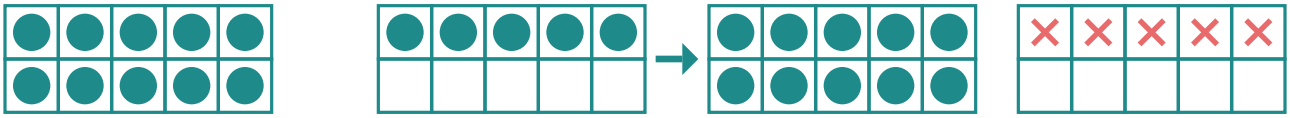
Name: _____ Date: _____

Take away the extra ones. Get to 10.

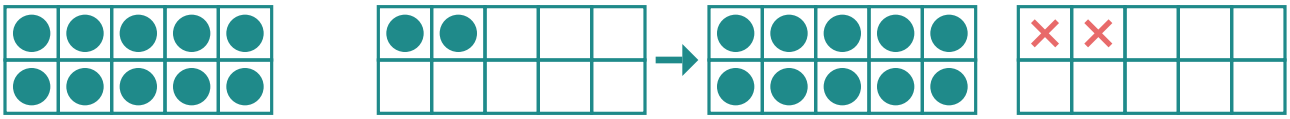
Before After



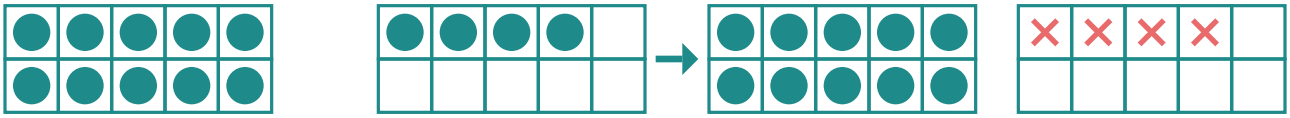
Example: 13 - 3 = 10



15 - ☐ = 10



12 - ☐ = 10



14 - ☐ = 10

© 2026 Learning Made Simple

LEARNING
MADE SIMPLE

Reach 10, Then Take the Rest

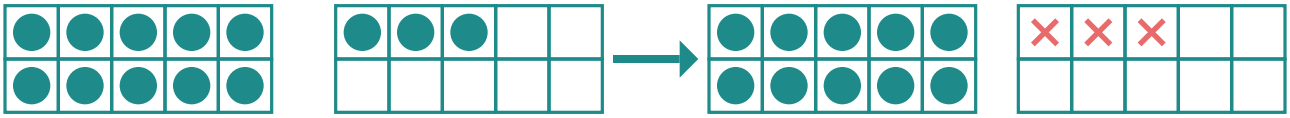
Grade 1 Math | Subtraction Fact Strategies

Name: _____ Date: _____

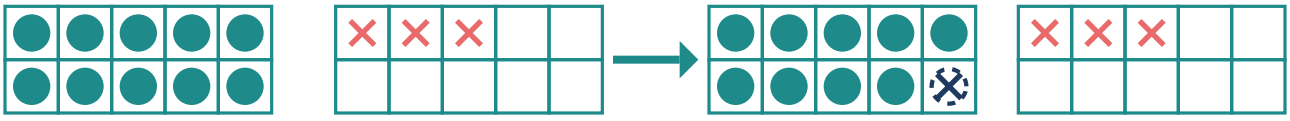
First get to 10. Then take the rest.

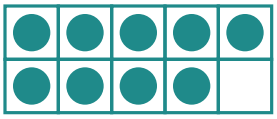
✕ first take to 10 ⊗ second take

1. Take 3 to reach 10. 13 - 3 = 10



2. The 3 are gone. Take 1 more from the ten. 10 - 1 = 9

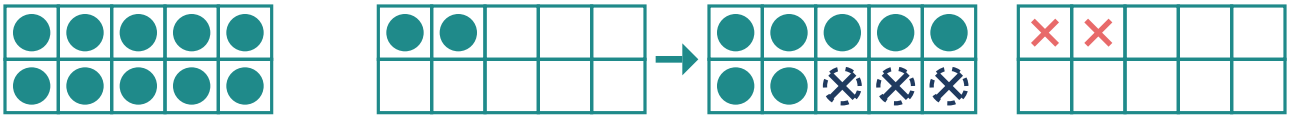




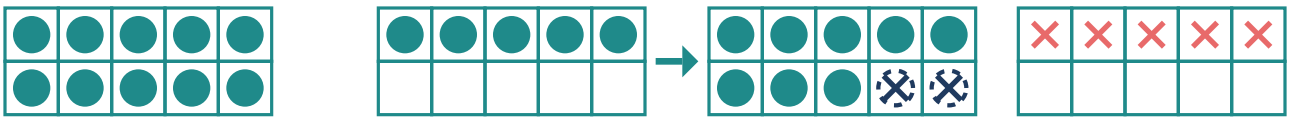
3. 13 - 4 = 13 - 3 - 1 = 9

9 dots are left.

First, get to 10. Then take the rest.



12 - ☐ - ☐ = 10 - ☐ = ☐



15 - ☐ - ☐ = 10 - ☐ = ☐

© 2026 Learning Made Simple

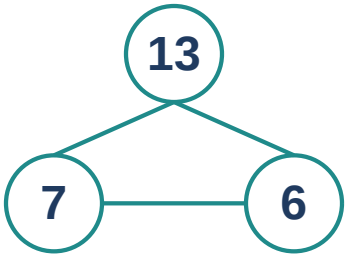
LEARNING
MADE SIMPLE

Use Addition to Subtract

Grade 1 Math | Subtraction Fact Strategies

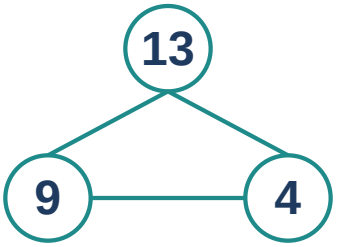
Name: _____ Date: _____

Know an addition fact? Use it to subtract.

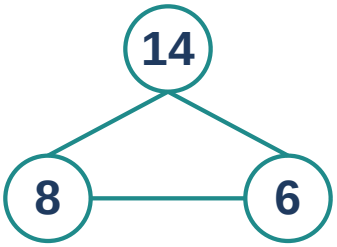


Example: 7 + 6 = 13
13 - 6 = 7
13 - 7 = 6

A. Complete the family.



9 + 4 = 13 **13 - 4 = ☐** **13 - 9 = ☐**



8 + 6 = 14 **14 - 6 = ☐** **14 - 8 = ☐**

B. Think addition to subtract.

15 - 9 = ☐ **Think: 9 + ☐ = 15**

12 - 7 = ☐ **Think: 7 + ☐ = 12**

© 2026 Learning Made Simple

LEARNING
MADE SIMPLE

Pick Your Strategy

Grade 1 Math | Subtraction Fact Strategies

Name: _____ Date: _____

Pick a strategy. Circle it. Solve.

14 - 3 = ☐

I used: Count Back | Count Up | Make 10 | Use Addition

13 - 11 = ☐

I used: Count Back | Count Up | Make 10 | Use Addition

16 - 8 = ☐

I used: Count Back | Count Up | Make 10 | Use Addition

12 - 5 = ☐

I used: Count Back | Count Up | Make 10 | Use Addition

15 - 9 = ☐

I used: Count Back | Count Up | Make 10 | Use Addition

11 - 4 = ☐

I used: Count Back | Count Up | Make 10 | Use Addition

© 2026 Learning Made Simple